

Word family: **upset / upsets / upset / upsetting**

Base word: upset

Part of speech: mainly **adjective**, **verb**, and **noun**

Related forms:

* **upset** (adj.) — 難過的；不高興的；心煩的；不安的

* **upset** (v.) — 使難過；使不安；打亂；推翻；弄翻

* **upset** (n.) — 不快；混亂；意外結果；爆冷

* **upsetting** (adj.) — 令人難過的；令人不安的

* **upset stomach** — 腸胃不適

* **upset the balance** — 打破平衡

* **upset a plan / schedule** — 打亂計劃 / 時間表

* **upset someone** — 令某人不開心

* **be upset about / by / with** — 對.....不開心 / 被.....弄得難過 / 對某人不滿

Useful expressions / extensions:

* **feel upset**

* **be upset about something**

* **be upset by something**

* **be upset with someone**

* **get upset**

* **upset someone**

* **upset a plan**

* **upset the balance**

* **upset the order**

* **upset stomach**

* **an upset**

* **a major upset**

* **upsetting news**

* **upsetting experience**

Meaning in this passage

> ...that part mattered a lot to me because it showed that he understood exactly why I had been
upset.

Here, **upset** means:

emotionally hurt, unhappy, or disturbed by what happened — 難過的；不開心的；受到傷害的

The speaker was upset because Kevin had publicly blamed them unfairly.

****中文翻譯：****

那表示他真的明白我為甚麼會****不開心 / 難受****。

So here:

**upset = 因某件事而感到情緒受影響、難過、不安或心煩**

1. **upset (adj. : 難過的 ; 不開心的) — 難過 ; 不高興**

This is the exact sense used in your passage.

Practice 1 — original sentence

> He understood exactly why I had been ****upset****.

他真的明白我為甚麼會****不開心 / 難受****。

Practice 2

> She was ****upset**** after the argument.

爭吵後，她感到很****難過****。

Practice 3

> I was really ****upset**** by what he said.

他的話令我真的很****難受****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****upset = 因不愉快的事情而感到難過、不安、心煩或情緒受傷****

2. **feel upset — 感到難過 / 心煩**

Practice 1

> I ****felt upset**** after the meeting.

會議後我感到很****不開心****。

Practice 2

> It's normal to **feel upset** after being treated unfairly.

被不公平對待後感到**難受**是很自然的。

MCQ-ready definition:

feel upset = 處於難過、不安或心煩的情緒狀態

3. **get upset** — 變得難過 / 心煩

Practice 1

> He **got upset** when he heard the criticism.

他聽到批評後變得很**不開心**。

Practice 2

> Don't **get upset** over one mistake.

不要因為一個錯誤就太**難過**。

MCQ-ready definition:

get upset = 從原本平靜變成情緒不安、難過或心煩

4. **be upset about something** — 對某事感到難過

Practice 1

> She was **upset about the misunderstanding**.

她對那場誤會感到很**難過**。

Practice 2

> I was **upset about what happened**.

我對發生的事情感到很**不開心**。

MCQ-ready definition:

****be upset about X = 因 X 而感到難過或心煩****

5. ****be upset by something — 被某事弄得難過 / 不安****

Practice 1

> I was ****upset by his comment****.

他的評論令我很****難受****。

Practice 2

> She was deeply ****upset by the news****.

那個消息令她非常****難過****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****be upset by X = X 是造成情緒難受或不安的原因****

6. ****be upset with someone — 對某人不滿 / 生氣****

This can be slightly stronger and more interpersonal.

Practice 1

> I was ****upset with Kevin**** for blaming me unfairly.

我因 Kevin 不公平地怪責我而對他很****不滿 / 生氣****。

Practice 2

> She's still ****upset with me****.

她仍然對我****不高興****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****be upset with someone = 因某人的行為而對他感到不滿、難過或生氣****

7. ****upset someone (verb : 令某人難過) — 令某人不開心 ; 使難受****

Practice 1

> I didn't mean to **upset you**.

我不是故意要**令你難過**。

Practice 2

> His words **upset me** more than I expected.

他的話比我想像中更**令我難受**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****upset someone = 令某人感到難過、不安或心煩****

8. ****upsetting (令人難過的 ; 令人不安的) — 令人難受的****

Practice 1

> It was an **upsetting experience**.

那是一段**令人難過的經歷**。

Practice 2

> The news was extremely **upsetting**.

那個消息非常**令人不安 / 難受**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****upsetting = 會令某人感到難過、不安或情緒受影響的****

9. ****upsetting news / experience — 令人難過的消息 / 經歷****

Practice 1

> She received some **upsetting news**.

她收到了一些**令人難過的消息**。

Practice 2

> Being blamed in public was an **upsetting experience**.

當眾被怪責是一段**令人難受的經歷**。

MCQ-ready definition:

upsetting X = 會帶來情緒不安或難過的 X

10. **upset (verb : 打亂計劃 / 安排) — 打亂 ; 擾亂**

A major separate verb sense.

Practice 1

> The delay **upset our plans**.

延誤**打亂了我們的計劃**。

Practice 2

> The weather **upset the schedule**.

天氣**打亂了時間表**。

MCQ-ready definition:

upset a plan/schedule = 令原本安排好的計劃、次序或時間受到破壞

11. **upset the balance — 打破平衡**

Practice 1

> The change **upset the balance** between the two sides.

這個變化**打破了雙方的平衡**。

Practice 2

> Too much pressure can **upset the balance** of the system.

過大壓力可能**破壞系統的平衡**。

MCQ-ready definition:

upset the balance = 破壞原本穩定或均衡的狀態

12. **upset the order — 打亂秩序 / 次序**

Practice 1

> The interruption **upset the order** of the programme.

中斷**打亂了節目的次序**。

Practice 2

> Moving one part may **upset the whole order**.

移動其中一部分可能會**打亂整體安排**。

MCQ-ready definition:

upset the order = 破壞原本的次序或有序安排

13. **upset (verb : 弄翻 ; 打翻) — 弄翻 ; 打翻**

A physical sense.

Practice 1

> He accidentally **upset the cup**.

他不小心**打翻了杯子**。

Practice 2

> The dog **upset the bowl**.

那隻狗**弄翻了碗**。

MCQ-ready definition:

upset something = 令容器或物件失去平衡而翻倒

14. **upset (noun : 不快 ; 困擾) — 不快 ; 煩惱**

Practice 1

> The incident caused a lot of **upset**.

那件事造成很多**不快和困擾**。

Practice 2

> There was considerable **upset** after the announcement.

公告後出現了相當大的**不安 / 不滿**。

MCQ-ready definition:

upset = 因某件事造成的情緒困擾、不快或不安

15. **an upset** (意外結果 ; 爆冷) — 爆冷 ; 意外勝負結果

A major noun sense in sports and competition.

Practice 1

> The match ended in a major **upset**.

比賽以一場大**爆冷**收場。

Practice 2

> The lower-ranked player caused an **upset**.

排名較低的選手爆出了**冷門**。

MCQ-ready definition:

an upset = 比賽或競爭中出現出乎預料的結果，通常是被看低的一方擊敗被看好的一方

16. **upset a stronger opponent** — 爆冷擊敗較強對手

Verb sports sense.

Practice 1

> The underdog **upset** the defending champion.

不被看好的選手**爆冷擊敗衛冕冠軍**。

Practice 2

> The team **upset** a much stronger opponent.

該隊**爆冷擊敗**了一支強得多的對手。

MCQ-ready definition:

upset an opponent = 在被普遍看低的情況下意外擊敗對手

17. **upset stomach** — 腸胃不適

A very common fixed compound.

Practice 1

> I have an **upset stomach**.

我有點**腸胃不適**。

Practice 2

> The food gave him an **upset stomach**.

那些食物令他**腸胃不舒服**。

MCQ-ready definition:

upset stomach = 胃腸不適，可能包括噁心、胃痛或消化不良

18. **upset** (adj. : 失調的；不正常的) — 失調的

Less common as a free adjective, but present in fixed/technical combinations.

Practice 1

> An **upset stomach** can make it hard to eat.

腸胃不適會令人難以進食。

Practice 2

> The system was temporarily **upset** by the sudden change.

系統因突然改變而短暫**失調**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****upset = disturbed from a normal or balanced state****

19. ****upset (使某人心神不寧) — 使不安 ; 擾亂情緒****

Practice 1

> The argument ****upset her for the rest of the day****.

那場爭吵令她整天都****心神不寧****。

Practice 2

> Try not to let one comment ****upset you****.

不要讓一句說話就****擾亂你的情緒****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****upset someone = 令某人的情緒平衡受到干擾****

Important distinction 1: ****upset vs sad****

****sad****

focuses specifically on sadness.

****upset****

broader and can include:

- * sadness
- * anger
- * worry
- * emotional hurt
- * agitation

In your passage, ****upset**** is better than ****sad****, because the speaker was hurt, angry, embarrassed, and disturbed—not simply sad.

Important distinction 2: **upset vs angry**

angry

focuses on anger.

upset

broader emotional disturbance.

Someone can be upset without being angry.

Important distinction 3: **upset vs hurt**

hurt

focuses on emotional pain.

upset

focuses on overall emotional disturbance.

Kevin's words **hurt** the speaker, and the speaker became **upset**.

Important distinction 4: **upset vs embarrassed**

Very relevant to your passage.

embarrassed

socially awkward or exposed.

upset

general emotional hurt/disturbance.

So:

> Kevin embarrassed me in front of the group.

> → I felt upset afterward.

Important distinction 5: **upset** vs **frustrated**

frustrated

blocked from achieving something.

upset

emotionally disturbed more broadly.

Kevin is **frustrated** because he thinks progress is blocked.
The narrator is **upset** because of the unfair public accusation.

Important distinction 6: **upset** vs **distressed**

distressed

stronger and more serious emotional suffering.

upset

common everyday word and can range from mild to fairly strong.

Important distinction 7: **be upset about** vs **be upset with**

upset about X

X = situation/topic

> upset about the mistake

因錯誤而不開心

upset with someone

someone = target of displeasure

> upset with Kevin

對 Kevin 不滿

Important distinction 8: ****upset by vs upset about****

****upset by****

emphasizes direct cause.

> upset by his words

被他的話弄得難受

****upset about****

emphasizes topic/situation.

> upset about the argument

對爭吵感到難過

There is overlap.

Important distinction 9: ****upset as adjective vs upset as verb****

Adjective

> I was upset.

我很難過。

Verb

> His comment upset me.

他的評論令我難過。

Same form, different grammar.

Important distinction 10: ****upset as emotional verb vs upset a plan****

Emotional

> The news upset me.

消息令我難過。

Structural

> The delay upset the plan.

延誤打亂計劃。

A major polysemy split.

Important distinction 11: **upset a cup vs upset a person**

Object

> upset the cup

弄翻杯子

Person

> upset Kevin

令 Kevin 不開心

Same verb, radically different meanings.

Important distinction 12: **an upset vs upset feeling**

upset uncountable:

emotional disturbance

> cause upset

造成不快

an upset countable:

unexpected competition result

> a major upset

大爆冷

Countability changes the sense.

Important distinction 13: ****upset stomach is lexicalized****

It does not mean the stomach is emotionally sad.

It means:

****腸胃不適 / 胃部不舒服****

A classic fixed-collocation trap.

Important distinction 14: ****upsetting vs upsetting someone****

****upsetting****

adjective:

> upsetting news

令人難過的消息

****upsetting someone****

verb phrase:

> The news is upsetting her.

消息正在令她難過。

Family-extension note

****Upset**** is highly polysemous because its underlying idea is:

disturb a stable state

That stable state can be:

1. **emotion**

* be upset

* upset someone

2. **plans/order**

* upset a schedule

* upset the balance

3. **physical position**

* upset a cup

4. **competition expectations**

* cause an upset

* upset the champion

5. **physical condition**

* upset stomach

So the semantic core is remarkably consistent:

something was stable → something disturbed it

For your passage, the disturbed state is emotional.

Master comparison

Form / expression	Traditional Chinese	Core idea	
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upset (adj.)	難過的 ; 心煩的	emotional disturbance	
feel upset	感到難過	emotion	
get upset	變得難過 / 心煩	change of state	
upset about X	對 X 感到難過	topic	
upset by X	被 X 弄得難過	cause	
upset with someone	對某人不滿	interpersonal	
upset someone	令某人難過	cause emotion	

upsetting	令人難過 / 不安的	emotional cause	
upsetting news	令人難過的消息	distressing information	
upset a plan	打亂計劃	disrupt arrangement	
upset a schedule	打亂時間表	disrupt timing	
upset the balance	打破平衡	disturb stability	
upset the order	打亂秩序 / 次序	disturb arrangement	
upset a cup	弄翻杯子	overturn	
upset (noun)	不快；困擾	emotional disturbance	
an upset	爆冷；意外結果	unexpected competition result	
upset an opponent	爆冷擊敗對手	unexpected victory	
upset stomach	腸胃不適	digestive disturbance	

For your original sentence

> ...that part mattered a lot to me because it showed that he understood exactly why I had been **upset**.

Here:

upset = 因為被公開而且不公平地指責，所以在情感上受到傷害、感到難過和不安

A natural Traditional Chinese rendering is:

> 那表示他真的明白我為甚麼會**不開心 / 難受**。

The nuance here is broader than just **sad**. The speaker was likely feeling a mix of:

* **hurt** — 被傷害

* **embarrassed** — 難堪

* **angry** — 不滿

* **disturbed** — 心裏不舒服

That broader emotional mixture is exactly why **upset** fits so naturally here.